

Cindy Kuo

Mixed-Methods UX Researcher · Consumer Behavior, Payments, and Emerging Tech

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EDUCATION

Carnegie Mellon University — M.S., MIIPS

Pittsburgh, PA | Expected Jun 2027

GPA: 4.00

Integrated Innovation for Products & Services (MIIPS): graduate program spanning design, engineering, and business

Coursework: User Research, Innovation of Services & Experiences, Innovation Process, Product Strategy & Planning

University of California, Los Angeles — Master of Social Science

Los Angeles, CA | Sep 2024 – Jun 2025

GPA: 3.93

Coursework: Qualitative Research Methods, Quantitative Data Analytics, Research Design, Community-Based Research

- Evaluated the impact of 826LA's Field Trip Program through field observations, staff and teacher interviews, and demographic analysis

Santa Clara University — B.S., Psychology

Santa Clara, CA | Sep 2020 – Jun 2024

GPA: 3.86

Coursework: User Experience Research, I/O Psychology, Database Management Systems, Programming (Python & SQL), Statistics & Methods I–II

- Conducted mixed-methods UX research on the university's student/faculty portal (Workday); recommendations adopted by system designers

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Google — UX Research Intern, Consumer Payments (CPUX)

New York, NY | May 2026 – Aug 2026

- Led an end-to-end mixed-methods study mapping Gen Z's online shopping and payment journey — a 34-participant diary study, in-depth interviews, and a 500+ response survey — benchmarked against older generations, with AI-assisted analysis
- Synthesized friction points, payment-method drivers, digital wallet needs, and attitudes toward AI and agentic commerce into prioritized opportunity areas linking Google's existing products to unmet Gen Z needs
- Insights cited by PM and UX Design in a product review to shape Google Pay engagement strategy; delivered recommendations and a next-step research roadmap to cross-functional teams and leadership up to Director level through decks and interactive Figma AI prototypes
- Ran a competitive analysis of payment autofill across web browsers as a self-initiated second workstream
- Produced 4 video stories from the diary study and co-facilitated a Gen Z focus group to drive cross-functional engagement with the findings

LASER Lab, Santa Clara University — Research Assistant

Santa Clara, CA | Sep 2023 – Aug 2024

- Designed and executed quantitative research on organizational reputation, managing large-scale data collection and preparing datasets for analysis in SPSS

SCU Institutional Research — Team Leader, Student Assistant

Santa Clara, CA | Jan 2024 – Jun 2024

- Launched SCU's first Pulse Survey, a rapid-response student feedback system supporting the university's goal of strengthening students' sense of belonging; designed the survey and question bank and distributed it campus-wide to all undergraduate and master's students
- Analyzed results in SPSS and presented findings to the Pulse Survey Committee and Institutional Research faculty to guide future iterations

Up In The Chair — Intern, Project Lead

Nashville, TN | Sep 2022 – Dec 2022

- Led the UPTC Ambassador Program for universities and organizations; identified potential partners through quantitative analysis and created brand-consistent visual assets; named Uplifter of the Week

SKILLS

Research: Mixed-methods research (qualitative & quantitative), diary studies, survey design, in-depth interviews, focus groups, ethnography, thematic analysis, customer journey mapping & service blueprints, end-to-end study design, cross-functional collaboration & stakeholder communication

Analysis & Tools: R, Python, SQL, SPSS, Excel/Google Sheets, Figma (AI prototyping), Cursor, HTML/CSS